

Angira Shukla

Research Professional, Becker Friedman Institute,
The University of Chicago – 1307 East 60th Street, Chicago, Illinois, USA.
Email: angira.shukla@gmail.com
Mobile: +1(415)-746-0298

EDUCATION

University of San Francisco

MS in International and Development Economics (IDEC); GPA 4.0

San Francisco, CA

August 2021 - May 2023

Courses: Graduate Econometrics, Panel Data, Causal Methods, Math for Economists, Spatial Econometrics, Natural Resource Economics, Microeconomics: Theory and Application

Ramjas College, University of Delhi

Bachelor of Arts- Honors in Economics

New Delhi, India

July 2017 - Nov 2020

Courses: Intermediate Microeconomics-I&II, Intermediate Macroeconomics-I&II, Econometrics, Statistical Methods for Economics, Mathematical Methods for Economics, Linear Algebra, Development Economics, Indian Economic Development, Public Economics, International Economics, Money and Financial Markets

University of Chicago

No Degree Coursework

Chicago, IL

March 2024 - June 2024

Courses: Real Analysis; Grade: A-

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Becker Friedman Institute, University of Chicago

Research Professional under Oeindrila Dube

Chicago, IL

June 2023-Present

- Worked on three research papers with the PI by writing replicable data files and scripts for data cleaning, regression analysis, and data visualization. Worked with primary surveys, ethnographic datasets, geo-located weather data, spatial datasets, as well as national-level datasets on voting, education, and labor force participation.
- Ran a comprehensive endline analysis on an intervention to reduce Farmer-Herder conflict in Nigeria, including robustness checks.
- Supported field experiments with the field team at IPA Nigeria to ensure timely deployment of endline surveys, implementation, and data quality monitoring.

University of San Francisco

Lab Manager

San Francisco, CA

December 2022-May 2023

- Successfully managed 13 projects under Jesse Anttila-Hughes on environmental economics, ensuring that each project met its goals and was completed within its designated timeline.
- Provided technical support to team members, helping them with coding and troubleshooting issues as needed, resulting in increased productivity and efficiency.
- Monitored project progress by creating project timelines and schedules, coordinating with team members to ensure that all milestones were met and deadlines were achieved.
- Facilitated team meetings and provided regular project updates to the stakeholders, promoting transparency and effective communication.

University of San Francisco

Project Manager

New Delhi, India

May 2022-August 2022

- Recruited and managed a team of 5 field RAs to run an experiment to study the impact of high temperatures on pro-sociality at the Delhi School of Economics.
- Managed logistics of the 2-week experiment at Delhi School of Economics; constructed the experiment design and instrument; tracked and documented progress, prepared progress reports.
- Established protocols for the research design, analysis and implementation; responsible for recruiting participants, subject payments, and monitoring the experiment as well as submitting the IRB reports, and ensuring compliance with research protocols.

University of San Francisco*Research Assistant to Jesse Antilla-Hughes*

San Francisco, CA

May 2022-May 2023

- Ran an analysis on temperature effects on sex-work and STI prevalence in India. Cleaned and analysed more data to include more Indian states in the analysis.
- Generated a comprehensive code base for the project.

University of San Francisco*Research Assistant to Andrew Hobbs*

San Francisco, CA

Feb 2022-May 2023

- Co-authored a paper on evaluating the policies on banning stubble burning on pollution levels using syntetic controls design.
- Wrote code to scrape data from MODIS satellite on daily fires at 1km gridcell level as well as the code for analysis.

Centre for Social and Economic Progress*Research Intern, Under Visiting Research Fellow Neelima Khetan*

Delhi, India

February 2021 – July 2021

- Co-authored a paper on the evolution of India's Civil Society Organisations since independence.
- Combined qualitative research and NLP analysis of interviews with industry leaders to uncover trends in funding, impact measurement, regulatory environments, and private sector engagement.
- Wrote code to generate report figures and designed a survey for industry leaders addressing themes of funding, impact evaluation, legal frameworks, and private sector dynamics.

Centre for Public Policy Research*Policy Articleship, Under Chairman D Dhanuraj*

Remote

Oct 2020 – March 2021

- Primarily worked on an untitled book project on the economic progress and policies of Kerala, India.
- Ran quantitative analysis and wrote excerpts on trends in trade, agriculture and remittances in Kerala.
- Assisted the Senior Research associate of the Centre for Comparative Studies on Policy briefs, proposals, ongoing projects.

Seasonal Magazine*Economics and Finance Correspondent*

Remote

May 2020 – October 2020

- Interviewed 3 professors of Economics for the magazine podcast.
- Edited blogs and articles on the themes of Economics, Finance and Public Policy.
- Managed Twitter handle, churning 20+ tweets on daily updates in the fields

MASTER'S THESIS

Charity Begins at Home: Investigating How Culture Shapes In-Group Bias in Altruistic Behavior [Master's Thesis] 2023 [Paper]**Abstract:**

The paper investigates how individuals' identity and cultural context shape altruistic preferences, focusing on the interaction of multiple identity characteristics in decision-making. While prior research has explored the role of identity in economic decisions, little is known about how these characteristics interact with each other to influence behavior. I model altruistic preferences as a function of identity, culture, and need-based factors. For this, I conduct an experiment in two cultural contexts—traditional and cosmopolitan—in India. The study examines whether individuals' preferences for identity characteristics when giving to others differ across these contexts. The findings reveal that need-based factors, such as the efficiency of transfers and the relative income of the recipient, are the primary drivers of altruistic behavior across both groups. However, the cosmopolitan group exhibited a strong preference for giving to girls, regardless of the sender's gender. Notably, men in the cosmopolitan setting showed the most pronounced preference for giving to girls, leading to a negative effect on gender matching. These results suggest that, in cosmopolitan settings, gender preferences diverge from the sender-receiver gender match typically seen in traditional settings.

Do Commonalities Foster Altruistic Transfers? Multi-Country Evidence on Experimental Donations to Children, with *Bruce Wydick, Alessandra Cassar, Samantha Kassirer, Maryam Kouchaki, Lucius Caviola, and Luvuyo Magwaza* 2025 [Paper]

Abstract:

We develop a simple microeconomic framework to model and predict altruistic transfers from a potential giver to a potential receiver. We then present results from a novel experiment carried out among 2,334 adults located in specifically urban and rural areas in India ($n = 627$), South Africa ($n = 689$), and the United States ($n = 1,018$) who were asked to give money to two different children, “Anika” and “William”. Each of the children were randomly assigned characteristics to potentially match a participant’s a) gender, b) country, c) local community, d) religion, e) family size, f) favorite hobby, g) affliction with which the participant closely identified, and (in India) caste. Tobit estimations find that while women and men both increased giving in country matches by 6.5% and 6.8%, respectively, women also significantly increased donations based on commonalities in religion, hobby, and affliction. Men were unaffected by these latter matches, but significantly increased giving when incomes of children were lower. Common caste did not influence transfers in India. Commonalities had the greatest influence on the giving choices of South African participants. Structural estimations of our microeconomic model parameters largely support the importance of commonalities in both religion and shared hobbies for motivating transfers, especially among women and rural givers.

Impact of Agricultural Policies on Crop Residue Burning in India, with *Kajal Gulati and Andrew Hobbs*, 2023 [Paper]

Abstract:

Much of the empirical literature on accelerating the diffusion of agricultural technologies focuses on the adoption of technologies that help farmers increase profit or farm productivity. Yet, some agricultural practices that are profitable for farmers could harm human health and the environment, thereby leading to a market failure. Very little is known about the effectiveness of policies that could spur farmers in developing countries to disadopt such harmful agricultural practices and help address negative externalities arising from agricultural production. Crop residue burning as a means of preparing land for a new crop exemplifies such an agricultural practice that is profitable for farmers but causes significant harm to public health and the environment. In India, crop residue burning is widespread in the agriculturally-progressive states of Punjab, Haryana, and Uttar Pradesh, and evidence is mounting on the detrimental impacts of this practice on air pollution and human health in the surrounding regions. In order to remedy the market failure, the government has introduced both price- and quantity-corrective policies such as leveraging fines on burning, subsidizing alternative practices, raising awareness, and paying farmers to not burn in these three Indian states. Using a synthetic control method, this study examines the causal impact of these policy measures on the incidence of crop residue burning in these states. Our results suggest that these policies did not lead to a significant reduction in agricultural fires in the three states. Further, the magnitude of reduction would need to be three times as much as current reductions to observe a statistically significant impact. Yet, even if crop residue burning reduced by more than three times in the policy intervention period, it would have unlikely led to any meaningful change in air pollution levels in New Delhi.

Temperature effects on prevalence of sexually transmitted infections among at-risk female sex workers in India, with *Rajshri Suresh, Jesse Anttila-Hughes and, Shikhar Mehra*, 2023 [Paper]

Abstract:

Climate change is invariably influencing the lives of people, but the impacts are often unequal affecting vulnerable groups significantly more than others. The study looks at one such community of female sex workers in India, who are at a higher risk of exposure to sexually transmitted infections (STIs) and we aim to find if there exists a relationship between temperature and STI prevalence. We find that there is a non-linear relationship between the two, suggesting that there is an increased risk of STIs in extremely hot temperatures. We also find that there while there is no increased risky behavior on condom use, there is an increase in solicitation and decreased alcohol consumption among these women.

Menstrual health sensitisation, attitudes and scholastic performance: Evidence from impact evaluation in Delhi–NCR, with *Animesh Gadre and Mrinal Tomar*, 2020 [Paper]

Abstract:

Societal norms and stigma around menstruation in India encumber schoolgirls academically and prevent them from accessing the same opportunities as their male counterparts. Further, schoolboys absorb these norms and grow up to develop insensitive or negative attitudes towards menstruation itself, affecting women negatively at workplaces or home. This paper presents the results of two interventions—distribution of sanitary pads and Menstrual Health Sensitisation in the form of presentations, on the overall scholastic performance of girls in school. This was done in collaboration with CSR Research Foundation which installs sanitary vending machines in schools as a part of their social development agenda. Three schools were chosen randomly on the basis of a list provided by the CSR Foundation and the machines were installed at 2 schools in October 2019. 40 minute Bi-weekly sessions were conducted in one of these schools on menstrual health education for schoolgirls. We find that our intervention program has positive effects on sensitising schoolboys towards menstruation. Our program also proves to be impactful in increasing the attendance of schoolgirls and their self-esteem, but fails to have any significant effects on the ECA participation. Owing the exogenous effects of Covid-19, we limit our analysis to the short-run and omit the impact of our intervention on school grades. These results suggest mixed positive and null results of our intervention in the short-run.

TEACHING ASSISTANCE

ECON672: Development Economics (Graduate level)

Instructor: Andrew Hobbs

San Francisco, CA

Aug 2022-Dec 2022

ECON365: Behavioral Economics

Instructor: Robizon Khubulashvili

San Francisco, CA

Feb 2023 -May 2023

ECON280: Global Economy

Instructors: Bruce Wydick and Sandhyarani Patlolla

San Francisco, CA

Feb 2023 -May 2023

ECON111: Principles of Microeconomics

Instructor: Michael R Jonas

San Francisco, CA

Feb 2023 -May 2023

ECON111: Principles of Microeconomics

Instructor: Andrew Hobbs

San Francisco, CA

Feb 2022 -May 2022

Peer Tutor

ECON111: Principles of Microeconomics, Econ 120: Economic Methods, ECON311: Intermediate Microeconomics, ECON415: Mathematics for Economists, ECON615: Mathematics for Economists

San Francisco, CA

Feb 2022 -May 2023

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

• **Jacques Artus Award 2023, University of San Francisco**

This award is given each year to a graduate student in economics, that presents exceptional academic performance, but also his or her commitment to department welfare through service.

• **Schmidt Family Fellowship, University of San Francisco**

The Schmidt Family Fellowship provides 10 awards to selected Master's Degree students in the College of Arts and Sciences who have a research interest in climate change and energy, environmental justice and human rights, or ecological agriculture. The fellowship comes with a two-year tuition scholarship that totals \$25,000 along with additional travel grant.

• **Frédéric Bastiat Fellowship 2023, Mercatus Center, George Mason University**

The highly competitive fellowship attending master's, juris doctoral, and doctoral programs in a variety of fields including economics, law, political science, and public policy to introduce students to the Austrian, Virginia, and Bloomington schools of political economy as academic foundations for contemporary policy analysis, policy-relevant academic research, and other applied topics.

• **USF Travel Fund 2022, University of San Francisco**

The highly selective travel fund is extended to independent researchers at the College of Arts for research or other academic work that requires international travel. Managed two projects with funding of \$4000.

- **Runner up at Enactus India National Competition in 2019, 2018, and 2017 for Project Aarogya.**

The Enactus championship is an international competition for university students to showcase social entrepreneurship projects that address social, environmental, and economic challenges. We won 2nd place in the national for a project providing healthcare facilities in remote parts of the country.

- **1st position/35 teams, Egnite'18, Jesus and Mary College 2017**

Presented a business model for a social entrepreneurial venture in healthcare and won INR 50k as funding.

- **2nd position/50 teams, at YMCA 2017**

Presented a business model for a social entrepreneurial venture in healthcare and won INR 35k as funding.

PRESENTATIONS

Collaborative for Econometrics and Integrated Development Studies (CEIDS) Seminar-Speaker

A seminar series organized by the University of Notre Dame on international development. The seminar was virtual. Work presented: Charity Begins at Home: Investigating How Culture Shapes In-Group Bias in Altruistic Behavior

VOLUNTEERING

President

Women and Diversity in Economics

San Francisco, CA

Aug 2021-May 2023

Head of Project Aarogya

Enactus Ramjas

New Delhi, India

Aug 2018-Aug 2019

SKILLS

- **Survey Design:** SurveyCTO, Qualtrics, Soho Survey
- **Programming languages:** R (Very Advanced), Stata (Very Advanced), LaTeX (Very Advanced), Python (Comfortable), ArcGIS (Comfortable), MATLAB (Basic), Julia (Basic)
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Hindi (Fluent), Japanese (Intermediate)

SCORES

GRE: Quant 169/170, Verbal 165/170, Writing 4.5/6

REFERENCES

Oeindrila Dube
Professor
University of Chicago
odube@uchicago.edu

Bruce Wydick
Professor
University of San Francisco
wydick@usfca.edu

Soeren Henn
Assistant Professor
University of Wisconsin-Madison
soeren.henn@gmail.com

Jesse Antilla-Hughes
Associate Professor
University of San Francisco
jkanttilahughes@usfca.edu